

Morning raid at Home Depot shatters refuge for immigrants

BY BRITTNY MEJIA
AND RACHEL URANGA

Emma De Paz woke up at 2 every morning for 25 years to make soup, roasted chicken and tamales to sell to work crews picking up their day's supplies at the Home Depot.

She joined other immigrant vendors lining the side streets under tents and over grills in a makeshift community that was something of a refuge for Latino immigrants in the Hollywood area. Abelino Perez Alvarez and his wife sold orange juice, soda and water. Day laborers scrolled through their phones as they waited outside the parking lot in hopes of getting work.

Around 7:30 a.m. Thurs-

day, the refuge was shattered. Dozens of armed agents, many in masks, converged on the parking lot, blocking gates and surrounding the laborers and vendors.

"*Migración! Migración!*" people shouted — and scattered.

They jumped in cars, ran down streets. They hid in stores and construction sites and behind bags of soil in the Home Depot gardening section. Alvarez's wife opened the door of a passing car and jumped in.

"They came in on all sides," said Domingo Rueda Hernandez. Fearful, even as a resident with legal status, he ran behind bags of dirt in the parking lot with others.

"*Agarraron los indios,*" [See **Raid**, A9]



MYUNG J. CHUN Los Angeles Times



MYUNG J. CHUN Los Angeles Times

L.A. bus ridership falls amid anxiety

Metro reports a 10% to 15% decline since start of immigration sweeps. An incident in Pasadena stirs worry.

BY CHRISTOPHER
BUCHANAN,
COLLEEN SHALBY
AND HANNAH FRY

Reports of federal agents detaining commuters sitting at a bus stop in Pasadena this week have heightened concerns about immigration officials targeting public transportation — a key aspect of city life — in their efforts to carry out deportations across Southern California.

For thousands of Angelenos, many of whom are Latino and rely on the city's

vast network of buses and trains to go about their daily lives, the incident in Pasadena has brought a new level of fear and uncertainty for public transportation riders.

After June 6, when immigration agents launched a campaign in Los Angeles to find and capture undocumented immigrants, some residents have started to go underground, staying away from work, school, churches and other public venues for fear of being swept up in a raid.

Now, as many attempt to resume their daily routines, buses and trains have become yet another place to fear. There has been a 10% to 15% decline in bus and rail ridership since immigration enforcement activities began, according to Metro officials.

[See **Ridership**, A7]



BRITTNY MEJIA Los Angeles Times

AN IMMIGRATION raid occurred Thursday at a Home Depot, top, in Hollywood. Joshua Espinosa, middle, in orange, was arrested in the raid but says he was later released. Above, a food stand serves work crews getting supplies at the store.



ALEX WROBLEWSKI AFP/Getty Images

IRAN'S ALLIES may target American forces if the U.S. enters the conflict.

ANALYSIS

Gulf states fear potential fallout if U.S. strikes Iran

Weeks after opposing involvement in the Middle East, Trump weighs joining Israel in military action.

BY NABIH BULOS

BEIRUT — Last month, President Trump stood in the palatial ballroom of the Ritz Carlton in Riyadh and rebuked America's misadventures in the Middle East.

As Saudi officials and U.S. business leaders looked on, Trump said that too many of his predecessors were "afflicted with the notion that it's our job to look

into the souls of foreign leaders and use U.S. policy to dispense justice for their sins."

"In the end, the so-called nation builders wrecked far more nations than they built," he added. "And the interventionists were intervening in complex societies that they did not even understand."

A mere five weeks later, Trump appears to be on the cusp of his own Middle Eastern adventure, one with uncomfortable parallels to America's invasion of Iraq in 2003.

That conflict — which killed at least 100,000 Iraqis and some 4,400 Americans, lasted almost nine years and destabilized the region for half a generation after. It be-

came the prime example of the "forever wars" Trump railed against during his election campaign, and a lesson in the folly of intervening with no clear endgame.

For Trump's Persian Gulf and Arab allies, the prospect of a repeat performance has left them scrambling for a diplomatic off-ramp.

"There are no nations on the face of the Earth working harder than the Gulf countries today to calm the situation and stop this crazy war. They are absolutely against any military confrontation," said Abdulkhaleq Abdulla, an Emirati political scientist and commentator, adding that leaders of the United

[See **Iran**, A4]

National park visitors told to report 'unpatriotic' signs

BY JACK DOLAN

In his ongoing war on "woke," President Trump has instructed the National Park Service to scrub any language he would deem negative, unpatriotic or smacking of "improper partisan ideology" from signs and presentations visitors encounter at national parks and historic sites.

Instead, his administration has ordered the national parks and hundreds of other monuments and museums supervised by the Department of the Interior to ensure that all of their signage reminds Americans of our "extraordinary heritage,

consistent progress toward becoming a more perfect Union, and unmatched record of advancing liberty, prosperity and human flourishing."

Those marching orders, which went into effect late last week, have left Trump opponents and free speech advocates gasping in disbelief, wondering how park employees are supposed to put a sunny spin on monuments acknowledging slavery, Jim Crow laws and the fight for civil rights. And how they'll square the story of Japanese Americans shipped off to incarceration camps during World War II with an "unmatched record of advancing liberty."

The whole thing is "flabbergasting," said Dennis Arguelles, Southern California director for the nonprofit National Parks Conservation Assn. "These stories may not be flattering to American heritage, but they're an integral part of our history."

"If we lose these stories, then we're in danger of repeating some of these mistakes," Arguelles said.

At Manzanar National Historic Site, a dusty encampment in the high desert of eastern California, one of 10 camps where more than 120,000 Japanese American civilians were imprisoned during the early

[See **Parks**, A7]

Families of trans kids are on edge

They're unsure of the future after Supreme Court upholds Tennessee's ban on gender-affirming care for minors. **PERSPECTIVES, A2**

Dodgers commit \$1 million in aid

Team pledges financial assistance for families adversely affected by ICE raids. **SPORTS, B11**

Weather
Clouds, then sun.
L.A. Basin: 78/62. **B8**



7 85944 00200 5



CLAUDIA ELLIOTT

ICE PLANS EXPANSION

Agency will repurpose California City facility into an immigration processing center overseen by private prison operator CoreCivic. **CALIFORNIA, B1**